EsKrow+ Competitor Review: Track 3 Pitch Decks

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Summary

Our closest rival is **JuddyMalaeww (Pause & Check)**: same target users, same online shopping scams. Closest in how it works is **TrustMeBro (Airlock)**, which also holds money, but only for 5–30 minutes.

Eight of the nine teams warn or delay the buyer before a transfer. EsKrow+ is the only one that holds the money until the buyer confirms the shipment. That is our main strength. Our biggest risk is judge questions we have no scripted answer for yet (see What to fix).

How close each team is

Sorted from closest to least close. "Strongest point" is what we can learn from, not what we should copy.

Team / product	What it does	How close to EsKrow+	Their strongest point
26 JuddyMalaeww / Pause & Check	Asks the buyer one question before a risky transfer, then shows a warning with reasons for that case. Optional 30-minute pause	Closest. Same target users (age 20–29) and same problem: fake online shops. Their demo buys a ฿590 phone case	Tested with 10 users. Polished app screens. Sourced stats (median loss ฿2,800; only about 11% of losses frozen in time)
25 TrustMeBro / Airlock	Holds risky transfers for 5–30 minutes, with a one-tap recall	Closest mechanism (bank holds money), but only for minutes. Aimed at scams where the victim is on a call	Bank cost per case (฿2,200). Clear "no change to core banking" message

Team / product	What it does	How close to EsKrow+	Their strongest point
09 EmperorPenguin / P2P Shield	Blacklist, money-flow graph, 5-second button lock, risk tick box	Medium. Similar risk check, and the same 5-second countdown we use	Protects honest sellers from fake reports. Bold numbers, but mostly unsourced (>80%, ~90%, 100%)
28 iLoveKBTG / Anti-Scam Shield	Risk score on the receiving account, warning before transfer	Medium. Similar risk check	Strongest bank case: about ฿360M a year, with backup slides showing the calculation
08 TrustGuard	User sets 3 rules (usual area, trusted contacts, limit). Fail 2 of 3 = 30-second pause	Low. The team that used ฿18,000	Live prototype judges can scan by QR. Tester quotes
20 Second / K-SafeFirst	30-minute delay, alerts a trusted contact, watermarks ID documents	Low. Job scams	Very detailed screen flows (low, medium, high risk)
22 RAKbank / Mule Account Alert	Three-level account warning (white, grey, black horse)	Low	Survey of 100 people
23 NoWin / ScamLens	User pastes a suspicious message to check it before paying	Low. Job scams	Clear scope; says it is still a proposed pilot
17 K-SmartReserve / Ariel	Reserves money for credit card bills; extra delay on new recipients	Lowest	Links two problems: debt and scams

What we do better

We protect the money; the others protect the decision. Suggested line for the pitch: "คำเตือนบอกให้ระวัง แต่ EsKrow+ พักเงินไว้จนกว่าจะยืนยันค่ะ" Don't name other teams on stage.

- **Money is held, not just warned about.** The longest hold from any rival is 30 minutes. A warning can be tapped past; held money can't be touched by the seller.
- **Works without a warning signal.** Every deal is held, even when the seller's account looks clean. Rivals need a flag first.
- **Non-delivery is covered.** No shipment ID within 48 hours means an automatic refund. No rival handles what happens after the money leaves.
- **Only signed QR.** No other team defends against fake QR codes, and ours has a working proof of concept (`poc-qr-signing`).
- **The bank gains customers.** Rivals offer loss prevention or keeping customers. Ours also brings in new ones, because both sides must bank with us.
- **Story and legal basis.** The buyer's ฿20,000 loss becomes ฿0 by the end, and the design rests on the Escrow Act B.E. 2551.
- **Follows the no-bank-brand rule.** Five teams use K PLUS, KBank or K- branding (Second, K-SmartReserve, NoWin, RAKbank, iLoveKBTG). They were not stopped from submitting, so the rule may not be strictly enforced. We stay neutral either way.
- **Clean files.** Our slides are images, so they look the same on any computer. TrustMeBro's slide 3 showed a garbled title and overlapping text when opened in PowerPoint here.

Where they beat us

Three gaps, all fixable in what we say rather than on the slides.

- **Proof from real users.** JuddyMalaeww tested with 10 people, TrustGuard shows 4 tester quotes, RAKbank surveyed 100. We have no user testing on file.
- **Showing the product.** JuddyMalaeww, TrustGuard and Second fill their decks with real app screens. Ours is mostly diagrams, even though `demo-stage` already works.
- **Bank numbers.** iLoveKBTG shows about ฿360M a year with the calculation in backup slides; TrustMeBro gives ฿2,200 per case. Our ฿40M a year (slide 9) is smaller and has no source.

One useful fact from JuddyMalaeww's own test: 3 in 4 testers tapped past the old warning in about 3 seconds. Even with their improved card, only 2 of 4 card views are listed as stopping the transfer. That supports our point: warnings alone are not enough.

What to fix before 7 Nov

The PPTX was submitted on 30 Oct and can't change, so every fix below is to the script, Q&A answers or rehearsal. Ordered by how likely the judges are to hit it.

- [ ] **Answer "Why would a scammer agree to use EsKrow+?"** This is the likeliest attack: rivals protect every transfer, but ours needs the seller to create a deal. Add the "Not a protected deal" warning to the script; it is in the design and the demo but not the script. Open gap: the design has no warning for a transfer typed by account number.
- [ ] **Answer "What if the box contains a brick?"** Slide 7 says the money is held until the buyer confirms the goods. In fact the seller is paid when the buyer confirms the shipment details, or after 24 hours of silence, before the parcel arrives.
  - A scammer who sends a cheap parcel to the right address gets paid.
  - Keep the rule for 7 Nov, since slide 7 prints it. Answer with the line from our brief: we verify identity, money and the shipment event, not what's in the box. Both sides were face-scanned, so the seller can be traced.
  - Drop "ปลอดภัยเหมือนซื้อจากหน้าร้าน" from the closing line.
  - After the contest: consider paying on receipt, with automatic release some days after the shipment ID. This needs no carrier integration.
- [ ] **Keep the security sentence in.** Zero Trust, two-person approval and the tamper-proof log are marked "ตัดได้ถ้าเกินเวลา". This is the security track and no rival covers them. Cut detail from step 3 instead.
- [ ] **Fix the script against the slides.**
  - Slide 5 shows ฿7.48B, 24.4% and age 22–29. The script says ฿63,000M, 28% and age 20–29.
  - Slide 9's notes are a copy of slide 7's script, so nothing covers the ฿40M.
  - Find a source for ฿40M and ฿4,000M, or present them as an illustration. Nothing in the repo backs them.
- [ ] **Add the bank liability point to slide 8's script.** Since April 2025, banks can be jointly liable for scam losses unless they meet the regulator's standards. Rivals already use this; our legal document says EsKrow+ helps here.
- [ ] **Run a quick test with 5–10 people this week.** Use `demo-stage`. Ask buyers whether they would request a protected deal, and sellers whether they would accept being paid a day or more later. One real result in the pitch closes the proof gap.
- [ ] **Prepare the smaller answers.**
  - Revenue: how the bank earns from this. By law, fees can't come out of the held money.
  - Friction: normal transfers are not affected. Expect a challenge on a face scan for every deal, since the median scam loss is only ฿2,800.
  - Backup video: re-record any video that still shows ฿18,000.

Scope

Based on the nine Track 3 decks in the `Competitor's Project` folder, compared with our submitted deck `29_EsKrow+_Track3_3MinPitch.pptx` and its speaker notes. Every slide was opened in PowerPoint and read.

Most competitor decks have no speaker notes, so what they say on stage may differ from their slides. Their figures are quoted as shown and were not checked against their sources. None of the decks we read uses our ฿20,000 amount.